

COVENANT EYES ONLY — FIELD COPY

Threat Assessment — Entities of Interest, Central Europe

Preliminary profiles compiled from public records, financial data, travel manifests, and initial surveillance. All assessments are provisional. Further investigation required.

01 — Professional Theft Crew (Group)

STATUS: **ACTIVE — Under Investigation**

PUBLIC PROFILE: A professional theft crew specializing in high-value cultural property. The crew's lead operative is a German national with multiple prior convictions for theft, burglary, and art fraud. The crew operates on a contract basis — hired for specific acquisitions, disbanded between jobs. Known associates include antiquities brokers in Vienna and Munich. The crew is believed to have been contracted for the Prague operation approximately six weeks before case initiation. The lead operative is currently in possession of the object of interest. The crew's current location and operational status are under active investigation.

KNOWN ACTIVITY: The crew executed a theft at Prague Castle, replacing the object of interest with a forgery of sufficient quality to delay discovery. The forgery was produced with professional skill — material analysis indicates modern alloy composition inconsistent with the original. Following the theft, the crew moved the object through Vienna, where a test of the object's properties was reportedly conducted. The crew then moved to Munich, where the lead operative established a temporary base of operations. The crew is believed to be brokering the object for sale through a professional intermediary (see 02).

ASSESSMENT: Primary threat entity. The crew currently possesses the object of interest. The lead operative's behavior has reportedly become erratic — psychological assessment flags potential deterioration consistent with prolonged proximity to the object. Recovery of the object requires locating and engaging the lead operative. Threat posture: moderate to high — the operative's psychological state is a variable of concern. Further investigation required to establish current location and transaction timeline.

02 — Professional Brokerage Network ("Vantablack Compact")

STATUS: **ACTIVE — Under Investigation**

PUBLIC PROFILE: A professional brokerage network specializing in high-value, high-discretion transactions — primarily cultural property, antiquities, and objects with "special provenance." The network operates through a series of shell companies and offshore accounts, primarily routed through Zurich and Vienna financial institutions. The network's Central European operations are managed by a Hungarian national operating from Vienna (see 02 lead). The network does not typically retain ownership of objects — it facilitates transactions between sellers and buyers for a commission, typically 15% of the sale price. The network has no known ideological affiliation — motivation is assessed as purely financial.

KNOWN ACTIVITY: The network was contracted to broker the sale of the object of interest. The broker has secured a confirmed buyer (see 04) and has been moving funds through Zurich accounts in preparation for the transaction. The network has also been in contact with representatives of the Catholic Church (see 03), who are independently seeking to recover the object. The broker is believed to be managing multiple interested parties simultaneously — standard practice for maximizing transaction value. The transaction location has not yet been confirmed but is believed to be in southern Germany, near the Czech border.

ASSESSMENT: Entity of interest — transactional, not ideological. The broker's loyalty is to the commission, not to any party. This makes the broker potentially cooperative if approached with a superior offer or credible threat to the transaction. Threat posture: low — the network avoids violence as bad for business. However, the network's discretion and professional security arrangements should not be underestimated. Further investigation required to identify the transaction location and timeline.

03 — Catholic Church Recovery Team (Congregation for the Doctrine of the Faith)

STATUS: **ACTIVE — Under Investigation**

PUBLIC PROFILE: A Church recovery team deployed from Rome, operating under the authority of the Congregation for the Doctrine of the Faith — the Vatican dicastery responsible for defending Church doctrine and managing sensitive ecclesiastical matters. The team is led by a senior cardinal (identity under confirmation) and includes a Jesuit historian specializing in Central European ecclesiastical artifacts, plus a security attachment of assessed professional capability. The Church's interest in the object is public: the object was donated to Prague Castle by a Catholic noble family and is recorded in Church patrimony registries as a relic associated with St. Vitus. The Church considers the object its property and the theft a violation of ecclesiastical law.

KNOWN ACTIVITY: The Church team arrived in Prague approximately three days after the theft. The senior cleric visited Prague Castle and confirmed the forgery. The team has been conducting its own investigation, parallel to Covenant operations — interviewing museum staff, reviewing Church archives, and tracing the object's movement through ecclesiastical intelligence channels. The team is aware of the Compact's involvement and the existence of a buyer. The Church has authorized "extraordinary measures" for recovery — the precise scope of this authorization is unknown. The team is not currently hostile to Covenant operations but is operating independently.

ASSESSMENT: Entity of interest — parallel investigation with potentially conflicting objectives. The Church's claim to the object is legally defensible under ecclesiastical law but complicated by the object's pre-Christian origin (unconfirmed). The senior cleric's internal conflict — between institutional duty and personal faith — may create opportunities for cooperative engagement. The Jesuit historian is assessed as the most approachable member of the team. The security attachment's professional capability should not be underestimated. Threat posture: low to moderate — the Church prefers diplomatic resolution but has demonstrated willingness to escalate. Further investigation required.

04 — The Buyer (High-Net-Worth Individual, U.S.)

STATUS: **UNCONFIRMED — Identity Under Investigation**

PUBLIC PROFILE: The buyer is believed to be an American national of substantial financial resources — capable of funding a high-seven-figure acquisition. The buyer has engaged the brokerage network through an intermediary — a French art dealer with offices in Paris and New York. Funds have been routed through a New York-based holding company. The buyer's identity is shielded by multiple layers of professional discretion. Preliminary intelligence suggests the buyer is a public figure — described by sources as "very famous — you would know the name." Travel records indicate private aircraft movement from New York to Zurich within the timeframe of interest, consistent with transaction timeline. The buyer's motivation for acquiring the object is unknown.

KNOWN ACTIVITY: The buyer's intermediary has confirmed the purchase commitment and arranged payment. A private aircraft has been fueled and flight-plan filed for transatlantic travel. The buyer's representative has been observed at the Zurich private aviation terminal. The buyer is believed to be traveling to Europe for the transaction — current location unconfirmed but assessed as en route or in-country. The buyer has reportedly asked the intermediary whether the object "really works" — suggesting awareness of the object's anomalous properties, though the depth of this awareness is unknown.

ASSESSMENT: Entity of interest — the transaction endpoint. The buyer's identity, once confirmed, will inform engagement strategy. The buyer's apparent awareness of the object's properties raises questions about information sources — the Compact does not typically disclose operational details to buyers. The buyer's status as a public figure introduces operational complexity — any interaction carries risk of public exposure. Threat posture: assessed as low — the buyer does not match profiles for hostile acquisition. Further investigation required to confirm identity and motivation.

05 — Prague Police / Czech Authorities

STATUS: **ACTIVE — Parallel Investigation**

PUBLIC PROFILE: The Prague Police criminal investigation division, led by a senior inspector, is conducting a theft investigation following the discovery of the forgery at Prague Castle. The investigation is standard criminal procedure — the police are treating this as a property crime. The investigating officer is described in law enforcement records as methodical and thorough, with a high case resolution rate. The police are not aware of the object's anomalous properties. The investigation is focused on identifying the thieves, recovering the stolen property, and determining how the forgery was produced and substituted.

KNOWN ACTIVITY: The police have processed the crime scene at Prague Castle, interviewed museum staff, and begun tracing the forgery's origin. The investigation is currently focused on the Prague-Vienna corridor — known trafficking routes for stolen cultural property. The police are not yet aware of the Compact's involvement, the buyer's existence, or the international scope of the transaction. If the investigation expands, Interpol notification is standard procedure for cultural property crimes crossing international borders.

ASSESSMENT: Civilian law enforcement — parallel investigation. The police are not hostile to Covenant operations but standard protocols for civilian law enforcement contact apply. The investigating officer's competence means the police investigation will eventually intersect with Covenant operations — preparation for this eventuality is recommended. Police presence at Prague locations may complicate agent access. Threat posture: assessed as low — standard law enforcement protocols. Cooperation with civilian authorities is not authorized without Watch Commander approval.

06 — Foreign Intelligence Service (Unconfirmed)

STATUS: **UNCONFIRMED — Potential Concern**

PUBLIC PROFILE: Preliminary intelligence indicates that a foreign intelligence service — believed to be Soviet (KGB Vienna station) — has been monitoring Compact financial movements in Vienna for an extended period. The KGB maintains active surveillance of Western financial operations in Austria as a matter of routine. If the Compact's transaction pattern is identified and connected to the Prague theft, Soviet interest may activate. The KGB's interest would likely be operational — the Soviet Union routinely monitors Western activity near its sphere of influence, and the object's location near the Czech border (a Warsaw Pact nation) would be of direct interest.

KNOWN ACTIVITY: No confirmed activity at this time. The KGB Vienna station is known to operate surveillance teams capable of cross-border deployment. If activated, Soviet interest would likely manifest as surveillance of persons and locations of interest, with potential escalation to intervention if the object is perceived as a Western intelligence asset or if the transaction threatens Soviet interests in the region. The shrine site (L6) is located near the West German-Czech border — an area of known Soviet signals intelligence coverage.

ASSESSMENT: Potential complicating factor — unconfirmed at this time. If activated, Soviet involvement would significantly complicate operations. The KGB's professional capability and jurisdictional authority in the region are substantial. Avoidance of Soviet attention is strongly recommended. If Soviet presence is confirmed, operational security must be elevated immediately. Threat posture: high if activated, dormant at present. Source reliability: Covenant intelligence (preliminary), KGB operational pattern analysis (historical).

Additional entities of interest may be identified as the investigation proceeds. This assessment reflects information available at case initiation only. All assessments are provisional and subject to revision with new intelligence.